

2026 Midterms: Seventeen Reasons Why I Cannot Vote Democrat¹

by Terry Presgrove

October 3, 2026

The Democratic Party of today is not the Democratic Party I once supported.

And if anyone doubts the direction in which the party is moving, they need only look at the candidates it is advancing and the political victories we are witnessing.

New York City—the largest city in America—has elected Zohran Mamdani, a Democratic Socialist, as its mayor. Michigan Democrats have also nominated Abdul El-Sayed, a Muslim, for the United States Senate. El-Sayed has campaigned alongside far-left commentator Hasan Piker, who notoriously stated that “*America deserved 9/11.*”

El-Sayed's hostility toward Israel, his controversial statements concerning Jews, his association with Piker, and his receipt of donations from terrorist organizations have generated serious concerns among many Jewish voters and patriotic Americans.

My concern is with **political Islam**—the political ideology that seeks to apply Islamic religious principles to the governance of society. Sadly, I believe it has already taken poisonous root within the Democratic Party. It seeks to extend Islamic principles beyond personal faith and into the political and legal institutions of society.

Political Islam is no longer merely knocking at America's door. It has already entered its gates, and its growing influence raises a question we cannot afford to ignore:

Will America remain a constitutional nation governed by the principles of the Constitution, or will political Islam increasingly seek to reshape our laws, institutions, and culture according to Islamic principles?

If America fails to recognize this threat and act decisively to contain it, we need look no further than Europe to see the future that could await us.

In Texas, of all places, James Talarico is, quite frankly, a creepy leftist running for the United States Senate. He claims to be a Christian and even preaches sermons, yet he has publicly stated that Christianity and Islam are “*equal pathways to truth,*” describing God, Yahweh, Allah, Nirvana, and the Great Spirit as different names for the same divine reality.

He also stated that there are six biological sexes. That position stands in sharp conflict with historic biblical Christianity, as does his 2021 statement that “*God is nonbinary*” and that God is “*both masculine and feminine, and everything in between.*”

Sadly, Talarico is not alone in rejecting the biblical and biological understanding of sex and gender. **In recent years, the Democratic Party has been at the forefront of promoting gender confusion under the banner of transgender ideology.**

The Squad—including AOC, Ilhan Omar, and Rashida Tlaib—represents some of the most prominent faces of the radical Democratic socialist wing of the Democratic Party. Its members have repeatedly promoted policies and rhetoric that challenge America's traditional values and the principles on which this nation was founded.

What began as a small minority of Democrats in Congress has grown into a powerful DSA-driven force increasingly shaping the Democratic Party and its elections across the country.

These are not isolated developments. They are evidence of a broader political shift within the Democratic Party.

Even here in Oklahoma, the direction of the Democratic Party is self-evident. Although Cyndi Munson, the Democratic candidate for governor, does not describe herself as a socialist, her policy positions reflect a distinctly liberal agenda. She supports abortion on demand, favors expanding government, and opposes school choice. She also supports reinstating diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) programs that have been eliminated under current state policies.

DEI claims to promote fairness, but when people are judged, hired, promoted, admitted, or favored because of their race, sex, or other group identity, it replaces equal opportunity with identity-based preference.

That is not equality. It is discrimination by another name.

The influence of the Democratic Socialists of America and the radical Left is growing, while ideas once considered fringe are becoming increasingly acceptable within Democratic politics. Socialism is gaining ground. Open borders, cancel culture, and calls to defund the police are increasingly prominent on the Left. Hostility toward Israel is increasingly visible, while antisemitic rhetoric and associations are too often excused, minimized, or ignored when politically convenient.

At the same time, biblical convictions concerning the sanctity of life, marriage, gender, sexuality, and the family are under relentless assault by progressives.

What was considered radical only a few years ago is rapidly becoming part of the Democratic mainstream.

But What About the “Moderate Democrat”?

Some Christians will say, *“My state has moderate Democratic candidates, and I intend to vote for them.”*

There may indeed be Democratic candidates who are personally more moderate than the increasingly radical elements within their national party. Some may even hold positions with which I agree.

But elections are about more than the personality, ugly tweets or campaign promises of one individual.

Every elected official strengthens a political party.

Every vote helps determine which party controls Congress, state legislatures, governorships, committees, and ultimately the direction of public policy.

A candidate may personally disagree with the most radical elements within his party. But once elected, he still helps give that party greater political power and influence.

I am not merely voting for an individual. I am also voting for the direction of the party that individual helps empower.

That is why, for me, the claim that a particular Democratic candidate is “moderate” cannot be taken seriously.

The direction of the party matters.

There is a battle for the direction of this country. The policies we support—and the people we elect to advance those policies—will help determine the America our children and grandchildren inherit.

For me, as a conservative Christian, the following issues carry the greatest weight in determining how I will vote in the midterm elections.

1. The Sanctity of Human Life

I will never regard the deliberate destruction of an unborn child as merely another political issue.

Every human life is created in the image of God. Scripture reveals God's personal involvement in life before birth. David wrote, “*For You formed my inward parts; You covered me in my mother's womb*” (Psalm 139:13). And God told Jeremiah, “*Before I formed you in the womb I knew you*” (Jeremiah 1:5).

A nation that refuses to protect its most innocent and defenseless human beings has a profound moral problem.

Massachusetts, one of America's deepest-blue states, has passed laws supporting abortion up until birth. This is beyond the pale of biblical morality and reveals just how far the Democratic Party has moved from recognizing the sanctity of human life.

For me, this is the number one reason I cannot vote Democrat. At the national leadership level of the Democratic Party, what Massachusetts has done represents what I believe is the ultimate goal—their idea of a *“Final Solution.”*

2. Biblical Truth About Marriage, Gender, and Sexuality

God created human being’s male and female.

Marriage was established by God from the beginning as the union of one man and one woman. Scripture declares:

“Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh” (Genesis 2:24).

Jesus Himself affirmed this design when He said:

“Have ye not read, that he which made them at the beginning made them male and female... For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife: and they twain shall be one flesh” (Matthew 19:4–5).

No amount of political pressure, cultural intimidation, or ideological confusion can change biological or biblical reality.

A political party that cannot define what a woman is, and increasingly treats disagreement with gender ideology as hatred, **has abandoned reality.**

For years, the Left has sought to redefine womanhood in the name of transgender ideology. Women have been reduced to terms such as “egg producers,” “womb owners,” and “birthing persons,” while biological men who identify as women have been celebrated in women’s magazines, awards, and other public forums.

But biology does not change because political ideology demands that it should.

Women and girls should not lose athletic opportunities, privacy, or safety because adults refuse to acknowledge biological reality. Women’s sports were created to provide female athletes with a fair competitive opportunity. That principle is undermined when biological males are permitted to compete against biological females.

And when disagreement with these basic biological realities is treated as hatred, something has gone seriously wrong.

The failure of Democratic Party leadership to stand with the American people on this issue is another strong reason I cannot vote Democrat.

Most disturbing of all are efforts to subject children to irreversible medical interventions in the name of gender ideology. **Those who encourage or facilitate such procedures on**

prepubescent children should be held accountable for what I believe amounts to criminal child abuse.

This is not about hatred. It is not about denying anyone dignity or compassion.

It is about reality. Biology matters. Children deserve protection. And women should not have to surrender their rights to accommodate an ideology that denies biological reality.

3. Protecting Children and Parental Rights

Children are entrusted to parents—not to government, political activists, or educational bureaucracies.

Scripture places the responsibility for teaching and raising children primarily upon parents. Moses commanded Israel:

Paul instructed parents to *“bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord”* (Ephesians 6:4).

Parents should know what their children are being taught and have the authority to protect them from ideological indoctrination. The state should not become the substitute parent.

Children should not be used as experiments in political or gender ideology. They need truth, guidance, stability, and the protection of those who know and love them best.

Parents are the God-given authority and priority in raising their children—not the state.

4. Religious Liberty and the Freedom to Speak Biblical Truth

I will oppose every effort to drive Christianity from the public square, silence biblical convictions, or force Christians to violate their conscience.

Religious liberty does not mean that Christians are free to worship only behind the walls of a church on Sunday. It means we are free to live out our faith in every area of life—including our families, workplaces, communities, and public discourse.

Jesus commanded His followers to *“let your light so shine before men”* (Matthew 5:16). Scripture also tells us, *“We ought to obey God rather than men”* (Acts 5:29).

Christians should never be ashamed of biblical truth or intimidated into silence because our beliefs conflict with the prevailing culture. We should not be compelled to celebrate, endorse, or affirm what we believe contradicts the Word of God.

The government has no authority to determine which biblical beliefs Christians may express or which convictions they must abandon.

America does not become more tolerant by demanding that Christians keep quiet.

True religious liberty protects the right to believe, speak, teach, and live according to conscience—even when those convictions are unpopular.

Christians do not need permission from the culture to obey God.

5. Freedom of Speech and Freedom of Conscience

Freedom of speech is not a privilege granted by government. It is a constitutional right that protects the ability of Americans to speak, question, criticize, and disagree without fear of government punishment.

I oppose censorship, cancel culture, political intimidation, and government pressure designed to silence those who hold unpopular opinions. A free society must protect not only speech that is popular or politically acceptable, but also speech that challenges prevailing beliefs.

The First Amendment exists because those who framed our Constitution understood the danger of allowing government to decide which opinions may be expressed.

Scripture gives Christians an even higher standard. When commanded to remain silent, Peter and John answered, *“Whether it be right in the sight of God to hearken unto you more than unto God, judge ye. For we cannot but speak”* (Acts 4:19–20).

No American should be compelled to say what he does not believe, endorse what violates his conscience, or surrender his convictions to an ideological movement.

A society that permits only approved opinions is not free.

Freedom requires the right to disagree—and Christians must never surrender truth simply because the culture demands silence.

6. The Second Amendment and the Right to Keep and Bear Arms

The Second Amendment is not about hunting or sporting firearms. It is about the fundamental right of law-abiding citizens to keep and bear arms.

For decades, Democratic politicians and the political Left have consistently sought to erode that right through expanding restrictions on firearms, ammunition, and the ability of law-abiding citizens to exercise their Second Amendment rights. The ultimate effect of these policies is

always the same: more restrictions on responsible citizens while criminals, by definition, continue to ignore the law.

The Founders understood that liberty cannot survive indefinitely when the government alone possesses the means of force. The right to defend oneself, one's family, and one's home is not granted by government—it is a fundamental right recognized and protected by the Constitution.

There is also a biblical recognition that self-defense and personal protection have a legitimate place. As Jesus prepared His disciples for His departure, He told them, “*He that hath no sword, let him sell his garment, and buy one*” (Luke 22:36). Jesus clearly did not teach His followers that possessing a means of defense was inherently wrong.

I oppose the continuing effort to weaken the Second Amendment through ever-increasing restrictions on law-abiding citizens while criminals routinely ignore the very laws designed to control them.

The answer to criminal violence is not to disarm responsible citizens.

A government powerful enough to control every aspect of its citizens' lives should never be trusted to determine whether its citizens have the means to defend themselves.

The Second Amendment is not a relic of the past. It remains an essential safeguard of individual liberty—and the continuing effort to erode it should concern every American who values constitutional freedom.

7. The Rule of Law, Secure Borders, and Public Safety

A nation without secure borders is not truly sovereign.

For years, the political Left has increasingly opposed meaningful enforcement of America's immigration laws while supporting sanctuary policies and resisting efforts to secure the border. That hostility has now extended beyond disagreement over policy to increasingly aggressive efforts to obstruct and intimidate ICE officers as they carry out the laws enacted by the American people through their elected representatives.

When elected officials, political activists, and others encourage resistance to lawful immigration enforcement—or excuse those who physically attack or obstruct federal officers—they are undermining the rule of law itself.

The law cannot be optional simply because one disagrees with the law being enforced.

Scripture is clear about the God-given authority of government:

“Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God... For he is the minister of God to thee for good... he beareth not the sword in vain.”

— Romans 13:1, 4

Disagreement with immigration policy is one thing. Attempting to prevent federal officers from carrying out their lawful duties through intimidation, obstruction, or violence is something entirely different.

Democratic mayors and governors have been at the forefront of attacking ICE and federal immigration enforcement. Through inflammatory rhetoric, public statements, and political actions, many have helped create an atmosphere in which resistance to federal officers is not merely tolerated but encouraged. When elected officials repeatedly portray federal immigration officers as the enemy, it should come as no surprise when some individuals take that rhetoric as a call to action.

Attacks on ICE officers and organized efforts to obstruct federal law enforcement are an assault on the rule of law—dangerously close to insurrection and the kind of organized resistance that threatens civil order itself.

Legal immigration should be encouraged, but illegal immigration should not be rewarded or normalized. A compassionate nation can enforce its laws, secure its borders, and welcome legal immigrants without surrendering its sovereignty.

Likewise, law enforcement must be supported. Police officers and federal agents are imperfect, and misconduct should be investigated and punished. But demonizing those charged with enforcing the law, weakening law enforcement, and excusing criminal behavior does not create justice.

It creates chaos.

8. The Iran conflict—A Strong America and a Strong National Defense

Peace is best preserved through strength, not weakness.

America must be capable of defending itself, protecting its citizens, securing its borders, and standing with its allies. A nation unwilling or unable to defend itself will eventually lose the freedoms it failed to protect.

For more than four decades, Iran has been one of the most persistent threats to American interests and stability in the Middle East. The Islamic Republic has supported terrorist organizations, attacked American interests, threatened Israel, developed an advanced missile program, and pursued nuclear capabilities.

But there is another reason Iran's nuclear ambitions are so dangerous: the radical Shiite Islamic eschatology embraced by Iran's Mullahs. Their religious worldview includes expectations surrounding the return of the Mahdi and the coming of a final apocalyptic era. That makes the prospect of Iran possessing a nuclear weapon particularly dangerous. A regime driven by radical religious expectations cannot be treated as though its ambitions are merely political or economic.

Unlike the policies of the previous two Democratic administrations, which I believe merely kicked the can down the road, President Trump has been willing to confront that threat with military force rather than simply issuing warnings. In 2026, the United States launched major military operations against Iran, targeting its nuclear capabilities, missile forces, air force, navy, and support for terrorist proxies. Those operations severely degraded Iran's military capabilities.

That is what strength looks like. It is not a desire for war. It is the willingness and ability to ensure that those who threaten America understand there will be consequences.

Iran's leadership must understand that America will not accept a nuclear-armed Iran simply because confronting it is difficult or expensive. Military and economic pressure, diplomacy, intelligence, and the credible threat of further action must remain available until Iran's nuclear ambitions and support for terrorism are meaningfully constrained.

Watching Democratic leaders complain about high fuel prices is the height of hypocrisy. During the Obama and Biden administrations, they pursued policies that drove energy costs higher in the name of climate hysteria.

I understand that Americans are hurting at the pump. But there are times when defending national security requires accepting a temporary cost to prevent a far greater threat in the future.

If confronting Iran today helps prevent a nuclear-armed Iran tomorrow, weakens its ability to wage terrorism, protects our allies, and makes the world safer for the next generation, I believe that price is worth paying.

America cannot purchase lasting peace by continually retreating from those who threaten it. Peace requires strength. Deterrence requires credibility. And when deterrence fails, America must possess—and be willing to use—the military strength necessary to defend itself and its allies.

9. The Threat of Islam to the American Experiment

America can no longer dismiss the growth of *Islamism* as a distant or theoretical concern. Islamism is the political ideology that seeks to bring government, law, and society into conformity with Islamic principles, including *Sharia law*. Sharia can extend into civil and criminal law, as well as personal and family matters.

That raises a fundamental question: **Will the Constitution remain the highest civil authority in America, or will Sharia law increasingly influence American law and government?** Our founders established a constitutional system based upon individual liberty, freedom of conscience, equality before the law, and government under a written Constitution. Those principles were founded upon a Christian worldview and cannot be subordinated to a competing system of religious law.

New York City has elected Zohran Mamdani, a Muslim and Democratic Socialist, as mayor of America's largest city. Michigan Democrats have nominated Abdul El-Sayed, a Muslim

progressive, for the United States Senate. El-Sayed has campaigned alongside far-left activist comrades who have expressed the view that America deserved 9/11. Some Democratic-run school systems have even advised teachers not to associate radical Islam with 9/11.

These developments are not happening in a vacuum. They reflect the growing political influence of Muslim activists and Islamist political movements within the Democratic Party and demand that Americans take a hard look at what political ideas are gaining influence—and what vision of America will ultimately prevail.

Europe offers a warning America should not ignore. Large-scale immigration has changed the religious and cultural makeup of several European nations, while governments struggle with integration, national identity, security, and social cohesion.

Europe is confronting questions America may increasingly face: What happens when large Muslim communities remain culturally or religiously separate from the broader society? What happens when political movements seek greater influence over civil law and public institutions? America should learn from Europe's experience rather than wait until these questions become unavoidable here.

The issue is not whether Muslim Americans should be free to practice their faith. *They should.*

The issue is whether political Islam is compatible with free Western societies and whether it should be permitted to reshape American law and institutions. Religious liberty protects the right to worship; it does not require Americans to surrender constitutional government to Sharia law.

An ideology is not entitled to immunity from scrutiny simply because it is religious—especially when the American Left has shown little hesitation in subjecting Christianity and biblical beliefs to relentless criticism and attack.

Americans should be willing to examine political Islam, its goals, its alliances, and its understanding of Sharia law without fear of being branded intolerant or bigoted. Political movements should be judged by what they believe, what they advocate, and what they seek to accomplish. America can protect religious liberty without surrendering constitutional liberty.

If Sharia law is ever elevated above the Constitution, the American experiment will cease to be the American experiment.

10. Free Markets Rather Than Socialism

I have no desire to see America travel further down the road toward socialism.

Socialism concentrates power in government. As government takes greater control of the economy and increasingly expands into education, health care, energy, business, and private life, individual liberty inevitably gives way to government dependence and control.

The growing influence of the Democratic Socialists of America should concern every American who values free enterprise, private property, personal responsibility, and limited government.

Margaret Thatcher put it plainly:

“The problem with socialism is that you eventually run out of other people's money.”

The promise of socialism sounds appealing: economic equality, prosperity, security, and a government that provides for everyone's needs. The historical reality is far different. Centrally planned socialist economies repeatedly produced shortages, distorted prices, weak incentives, low productivity, limited innovation, and growing government control. The system attempts to replace the decisions of millions of individuals with the decisions of government planners—and history has shown how poorly that works.

Socialism promises that government can provide more while asking less of the individual. In practice, it concentrates power, diminishes economic freedom, weakens personal responsibility, and eventually struggles to deliver the very benefits it promises.

Socialism is the delicious, appealing red apple that may look perfect on the outside—but is rotten to the core.

11. Personal Responsibility Rather Than Permanent Government Dependency

We should help those who genuinely cannot help themselves. That is compassion.

But creating generations permanently dependent upon government is not compassion.

It is a form of bondage.

Generations of children growing up without fathers have become trapped in a cycle of poverty, government welfare dependency, and broken families. What was intended to provide a safety net has, in too many inner-city communities, become an endless cycle of dependency, dysfunction, and despair.

Whenever possible, assistance should restore dignity, encourage responsibility, strengthen families, and help people become independent rather than making dependency a way of life.

The church has also abdicated much of its God-given responsibility in this area. Instead of leading the way in caring for the poor, widows, fatherless, and genuinely needy, too often the church has allowed government to assume responsibilities Scripture places upon God's people.

Government assistance can provide temporary help.

But government can never replace the ministry of Christ through His people.

12. Racial Unity Rather Than Racial Division

America has made tremendous progress in overcoming its history of racial discrimination. Yet *Critical Race Theory* and related ideologies threaten to deepen racial division by encouraging Americans to view one another primarily through the lens of race.

There are *race hustlers* among us who make millions of dollars by inflaming racial tensions and keeping Americans divided. They view virtually every event through the prism of race, reducing people to racial categories rather than treating them as individuals.

Instead of emphasizing our common humanity, our equal standing under the law, and our identity as fellow Americans, these ideologies divide people into categories of oppressor and oppressed based largely upon race.

That is not racial reconciliation. It is the commercialization of racial division.

DEI—Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion—has helped institutionalize this way of thinking. While presented as a means of promoting fairness and inclusion, DEI programs instead make race, sex, and group identity central to decisions involving hiring, admissions, promotion, education, and access to opportunities.

When people are judged by group identity rather than individual character, ability, and achievement, equality under the law is replaced by identity-based preference.

Racism is wrong regardless of who practices it or who is its victim. We should reject racial hatred and discrimination wherever they are found. But replacing one form of racial prejudice with another will never produce unity.

Scripture tells us that God “*hath made of one blood all nations of men*” (Acts 17:26). Every person is created in the image of God, and in Christ “*there is neither Jew nor Greek... for ye are all one in Christ Jesus*” (Galatians 3:28).

Our race does not determine our worth, guilt, innocence, or moral standing before God.

America will not become stronger by teaching our children to see one another first as members of competing racial groups rather than as fellow Americans created equally in the image of God.

We will not overcome racial division by continually emphasizing what divides us.

13. Support for Israel and Opposition to Antisemitism

The growing hostility toward Israel and the disturbing rise of antisemitism should concern every American—and especially every Christian.

Criticism of a particular Israeli government or its policies is one thing.

The growing effort to isolate, delegitimize, and demonize Israel—and to hold the world's only Jewish state to standards not demanded of other nations—is something entirely different.

The willingness of elements of the political Left, and increasingly many within the Democratic Party, to tolerate, excuse, or minimize antisemitic rhetoric and associations when politically convenient should be recognized for what it is.

Antisemitism does not become acceptable simply because it comes from a politically useful ally or is disguised as opposition to Israel.

Christians should also recognize that Israel's existence is not merely a matter of modern geopolitics. Scripture foretold Israel's regathering to its land:

“For I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land” (Ezekiel 36:24).

And the Apostle Paul makes clear that God has not abandoned Israel:

“Hath God cast away his people? God forbid... God hath not cast away his people which he foreknew” (Romans 11:1–2).

God is not finished with Israel. Whatever one's position on the policies of a particular Israeli government, Christians should understand that Israel remains part of God's prophetic purposes.

The Jewish people have endured centuries of persecution, and the growing willingness to excuse or overlook antisemitism for political purposes is a dangerous direction for America.

Opposition to antisemitism should not depend upon politics. Nor should America's support for Israel—the only true democracy in the Middle East.

14. Limited Government and Constitutional Liberty

The larger government becomes, the smaller the individual ultimately becomes.

Government was never intended to control every aspect of American life.

The Constitution was designed to restrain government because those who framed it understood something increasingly forgotten today:

Power is dangerous when concentrated—and even more dangerous when it is placed beyond the reach of the people.

15. Changing the Rules to Gain Political Power

The issue is not simply the policies Democrats want to enact. It is increasingly about changing the rules and institutions of government to make those policies easier to impose.

Democrats and progressive activists have increasingly called for expanding the Supreme Court, eliminating or severely weakening the Senate filibuster, and granting statehood to Washington, D.C. Some Democrats have also advocated a path to statehood for Puerto Rico. These proposals would fundamentally alter the political balance of the federal government—making any Republican election win practically impossible.

The Supreme Court currently has nine justices, but proposals have been advanced to add additional seats—one current proposal would increase the Court from nine to thirteen. Democratic leaders have also refused to rule out such changes.

At the same time, Democrats have repeatedly pushed to eliminate the Senate's 60-vote legislative filibuster, which would allow a bare Senate majority to pass legislation that currently requires broader bipartisan support.

D.C. statehood is also a longstanding Democratic priority. Adding D.C. would create two additional Senate seats, while Puerto Rico statehood could potentially create two more. Whatever one's position on statehood itself, the political consequences are obvious: these changes would dramatically alter the balance of power in Washington.

Changing the composition of the Supreme Court, removing the Senate's principal procedural check on majority rule, and adding new states is not simply ordinary policymaking. It changes the rules by which political power is gained and exercised.

When a political party seeks to change the institutions and rules themselves to make its agenda easier to advance, Americans need to see it for what it is—a glaring red flag.

Elections should be won by persuading voters—not by changing the rules to make political opposition more difficult.

That is why I believe the stakes are so high. When—not if—the Democrats regain control of all three branches of government, I believe the America we know today will be no more.

16. Fiscal Responsibility

We cannot continue borrowing indefinitely, spending money we do not have, and leaving the consequences to our children and grandchildren.

On this issue, both political parties have failed miserably.

A warning often attributed to Alexander Fraser Tytler comes to mind:

“A democracy cannot exist as a permanent form of government. It can only exist until the voters discover that they can vote themselves largess from the public treasury. From that

moment on, the majority always votes for the candidates promising the most benefits from the public treasury.”

That warning strikes at the heart of America's growing fiscal crisis. Politicians promise more benefits, voters reward those promises, government spends money it does not have, and the debt is passed on to future generations.

Scripture gives us a sobering warning:

“The borrower is servant to the lender” (Proverbs 22:7).

Government generosity with borrowed money is not generosity.

Someone eventually pays the bill.

And increasingly, that bill is being handed to generations not yet old enough to vote.

A responsible generation should leave its children an inheritance—not an ever-growing mountain of debt.

17. The Growing Intolerance of the Left

The modern Left speaks constantly about tolerance, diversity, and inclusion while increasingly demonstrating little tolerance for those who disagree with its political, moral, or cultural agenda.

Traditional Christians, conservatives, and patriotic Americans are frequently portrayed as dangerous, hateful, ignorant, or intolerant simply because they refuse to surrender their convictions. Increasingly, disagreement itself is treated as evidence of hatred.

But disagreement is not hatred.

Holding biblical convictions is not extremism.

Opposing same-sex marriage does not make someone a homophobe. Believing that biological sex is real does not make someone hateful. Nor does opposing the influence of Sharia law in American civil society make someone Islamophobic.

Too often, labels such as *homophobe*, *transphobe*, *racist*, *bigot*, and *Islamophobe* are used not merely to identify genuine hatred, but to silence those who disagree.

That is not tolerance. It is ideological intimidation—ideological blackmail designed to silence anyone who dares to disagree.

Tolerance allows people to disagree. Ideological conformity demands affirmation and condemns those who refuse.

Christians and conservatives should be free to hold and express their convictions without being silenced, punished, or marginalized.

Disagreement is not hatred.

Biblical conviction is not extremism.

The real threat to freedom is a culture that demands conformity and calls dissent intolerance.

18. The Direction of America

Perhaps this is the greatest issue of all.

Every election is ultimately about direction.

Moses gave Israel a choice:

“I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing: therefore choose life” (Deuteronomy 30:19).

The principle is timeless: **our choices have consequences, and the direction we choose matters.**

One direction leads toward greater respect for life, faith, family, freedom, parental authority, national sovereignty, law and order, limited government, and individual responsibility.

The other moves America toward greater government control, open borders, socialism, secularism, moral and sexual confusion, ideological conformity, and increasing hostility toward traditional biblical values.

I know which direction I will choose.

After spending many years voting Democrat, I reached a conclusion more than two decades ago—one my younger self never could have imagined:

I can no longer vote Democrat.

This is not because I believe every Republican is good or every Democrat is evil. It is because **I believe biblical truth and direction matter.**

As a Christian, I recognize that America has reached a point where only God can save us from ourselves. But I also recognize my responsibility as a citizen to vote. My vote is about more than personal approval of an individual candidate. It is about the policies, principles, and political direction that vote will help empower.

So yes, I will continue to stamp the Elephant.

Not because Donald Trump is the ideal president, nor because I agree with everything said or done by every Republican politician. In fact, I see much to be desired in both Trump and Republican congressional leaders and even in the candidates presently running for office.

The truth is, in character, neither party comes close to representing Biblical Christianity.

But when I place the policies and direction of the two parties alongside the convictions I hold as a conservative Christian, the difference is clear.

It is easy to see why some may view this as a “lesser of two evils” choice. But my conclusion remains the same:

Though flawed, the Republican Party is clearly closer to the biblical principles I believe are necessary to preserve life, faith, family, freedom, and the future of this nation I love.

If you see it the same way, stamp the Elephant on November 3rd!

¹ *This paper addresses eighteen issues that have shaped my decision. Seventeen are reasons I cannot vote Democrat. **Reason 16—Fiscal Responsibility—is the exception.** It is an issue on which I believe both political parties have failed miserably.*